



Learning Space

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

PRINCELY STATES MODULE-3 (REVISED & NEW)



POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

INDEPENDENT INDIA

AIMS

1

**NATIONAL UNITY AND SECURITY
(NATIONAL BUILDING)**



2

**TERRITORIAL
INTEGRITY**



1 NATION BUILDING

THE CONSTITUTION OF INDIA

PREAMBLE

WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA,

THE CONSTITUTION OF INDIA

PREAMBLE

WE, THE PEOPLE OF INDIA,

INDEPENDENCE

(FREEDOM FROM BRITISH DOMINATION) AT THE COST OF PARTITION

- Large scale violence
- Forced migrations
- Resettlements

UNITY WITH DIVERSITY

Accommodating the needs/aspirations of the linguistic groups (National Unity)

SOCIAL WELFARE

- upliftment of the marginalized and disadvantaged sections
- protection of sub-regional identities

EQUALITY WITH SPECIAL PROTECTION FOR THE MARGINALIZED SECTIONS OF THE POPULATION

Directive Principles of State Policy

2 TERRITORIAL INTEGRITY

INDIA DIVIDED INTO PRINCELY STATES

Integration and
Consolidation (TI).
Preserve, consolidate
and strengthen
national unity.

RE-DRAWING OF THE INTERNAL BOUNDARIES

establishing the
administration of the
country

INDIA TO BE BUILT UPON

Nationalism,
Secularism and
Democracy

TERRITORIAL INTEGRATION



1 BRITISH INDIA

British Indian Provinces (under control of British Government)



Princely States (ruled by Princes)

2 PRINCELY STATES

- 40 percent territory occupied by around 560 small and large states.
- Princely states enjoyed control over internal matters as long as they accepted British supremacy - called paramountcy or suzerainty of British.

3 Accession-Integration-Reorganization

PROBLEM!

- 1 With the end of the British rule in India, paramountcy of the British crown in India would collapse.
 - Around 560 states to become legally independent – Free to join either India or Pakistan or remain independent if they so desired.
 - Rulers of states were to decide.
- 2
 - So, India would be further divided into smaller groups.
 - Unity and democracy would be threatened.
 - Princely states unwilling to become democratic.
- 3
 - Interim government in India – India cannot be further divided into smaller principalities.
 - Muslim League – States should be left to decide for themselves.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

QUESTION OF PRINCELY STATES



- 1 Lord Wavell, the Governor General of India, initiated the discussion after the end of Second World war and urged for the transfer of power.
- 2 Over 500 Princely states of varied sizes were to integrate into the Indian Union.
- 3 The East India Company furthered the decline of the Mughal empire and saw the Indian rulers as strategic allies to check the ambitions of the French.
- 4 By the 1940s, the status of the Princely states after independence became ambiguous. Cabinet Mission of 1946 did not speak of the status of the Princely States.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

FEATURES OF PRINCELY STATES



- 1 Most of the states had no coastline.
- 2 They were economically dependent on the British India for raw materials, industrial goods and employment opportunities.
- 3 Eventually they were dependent politically as well.
- 4 Several states had their own railways, currency and stamps.
- 5 They cared little for the matters of administration with the exception of Maharaja of Mysore and Baroda who established Universities, struggled for caste equality and promoted modern enterprise.
- 6 Some like Mysore, extended social and economic welfare besides initiating major reforms within the limited political freedom they had and made significant strides on the economic front. This was attributed to long periods of political stability in the region.

STANCE OF LEADERS



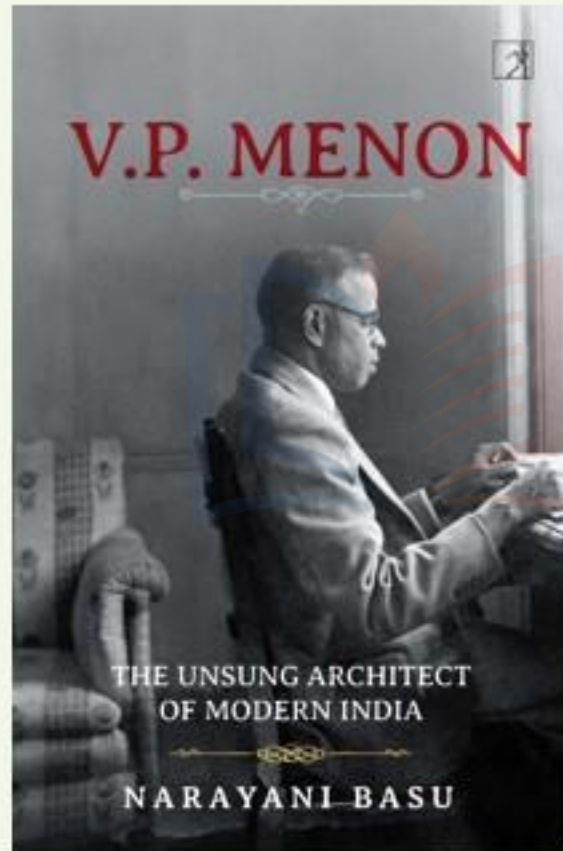
- 1** In 1946-47, J.L. Nehru was made the President of All-India States Peoples Conference.
- 2** Congress assigned the question of Princely states to Vallabhai Patel. In 1947, Patel urged the princely states to help the Congress frame the Constitution and establish good relations with the dewans of these states.
- 3** Gandhi asked Mountbatten not to encourage the States to declare independence. On 25 July, 1947 Mountbatten addressed the states and encouraged them to join the closest dominion. He asked them to sign the Instrument of Accession even before independence.

SARDAR PATEL



- 1** Skilfully and diplomatically persuaded these states to join the Indian Union.
- 2** Mountbatten and Patel agreed upon an Instrument of Accession through which the states would agree to transfer control of the following to the Congress government.
 - ✓ Foreign affairs
 - ✓ Defence and
 - ✓ Communications
- 3** Government strategy guided by three considerations-
 - People of the princely states wanted to be a part of the Indian Union.
 - Indian government was flexible and accommodated plurality in giving autonomy to these states.
 - Instrument of Accession - the princely states agreed to be a part of the Indian Union.

VP MENON



- 1 In late 1947, VP Menon toured India and tried to convince the Princely States to join India.
- 2 In exchange for their land, each ruler was offered a 'privy purse' depending upon the revenue of the State. Bigger and strategically important states were given better deals.
- 3 The rulers could retain their titles, personal property and palaces. Privy purse was given Constitutional guarantee.
- 4 In most states, land revenue and judicial systems were archaic. There was no popular representation in the princely states.

ABOUT PRIVY PURSE



- 1** According to Article 291 and 362 of the Indian Constitution, Privy Purse is a fixed, tax-free amount guaranteed to the former princely rulers and their successors. (abolished later)
- 2** The sum was intended to cover all expenses of the former ruling families, including those incurred for religious and other ceremonies, and would be charged on the Consolidated Fund of India.
- 3** Privy Purses were determined by several factors such as the state's revenue, whether the state had been ranked as a salute state under the British Raj or not, the antiquity of the dynasty, and so on, which resulted in approx $\frac{1}{4}$ of their earlier earned revenue.
- 4** In general terms, Privy Purses were a bargain, majorly a monetary bargain to uphold the sovereignty of the Indian state. In his own words, Sardar Patel said that it is a small price for the integration of India.

INTEGRATION OVER INDEPENDENCE



- 1 Congress feared the division of the country into several sovereign states.
- 2 On 5 July, Patel appealed to the princes to accede to the Indian Union and join the Constituent Assembly.
- 3 The Maharaja of Bikaner was one of the first Princes to support Patel when he realized that nationalism was irresistible. Bikaner integrated into India on 7 August 1947.
- 4 Baroda in support of Patel, joined the Indian Union on 1 May 1949.

TROUBLING STATES

JODHPUR



- 1** Jodhpur had a Hindu king, Maharaja Hanvant Singh with a Hindu population. He thought that since his kingdom bordered Pakistan, he might get a better deal by joining Pakistan.
- 2** A meeting was arranged with Jinnah on 6 August 1947. Muslim League offered Jodhpur post facilities in Karachi, unrestricted import of arms and supply of grains from Sindh. KM Pannikar, historian and dewan of Bikaner heard about it and asked Sardar Patel to intervene.
- 3** Sardar Patel, in a meeting with Maharaja on 10 August 1947 promised free import of arms and adequate grains to Jodhpur. Meanwhile the people of Jodhpur feared joining Pakistan so the Maharaja of Jodhpur finally joined India.

TROUBLING STATES

BHOPAL



Ultimately, joined the Instrument of Accession.

- 1 Bhopal was a state in Central India. It had a Hindu population with a Muslim ruler.
- 2 In 1944, the Nawab of Bhopal was the Chancellor of the Chamber of Princes. He was close to Jinnah and the Muslim League. He was unhappy with the end of the British rule.
- 3 Bhopal feared that India would soon be dominated by the Communists. So, on 14 August, Bhopal integrated into India. Bhopal thought only if the Congress and the Princes joined together, they would be able to detest the Communist overpowering Bhopal.

TROUBLING STATES

TRAVANCORE



But the Congress had a strong presence in the state.

- 1 The state was strategically placed at the southern tip of the subcontinent.
- 2 It had a highly educated population, thriving maritime trade and newly discovered reserves of Monazite to extract thorium (atomic energy and atomic bombs).
- 3 The Dewan of Travancore, Sir CP Ramaswamy Aiyar in 16 February 1946, declared that Travancore was to become an independent unit as it was before signing treaty with East India Company.
- 4 He went to the people in 11 June, 1947, seeking support for his independent Travancore by reminding them of their ancient past and how they defeated a Dutch fleet in 1741.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

TROUBLING STATES

INTEGRATION OF TRAVANCORE



- 5 Jinnah welcomed Travancore's call for independence in June 1947 and promised relations between Pakistan and Travancore.
- 6 Travancore was hopeful of British support if India refused to supply raw materials. It used to export Monazite to Britain so it was in British interest if Travancore remained independent.
- 7 Sir CP was attacked by a man on 25 July 1947 who turned out to be from Kerala Socialist Party. This scared the Dewan and he advised the maharaja to join the Indian union on 30 July 1947.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

TROUBLING STATES

JUNAGARH



- 1 Junagarh had not signed the Instrument of Accession with India till 15 of August, 1947.
- 2 Junagarh lay in the Kathiawar Western India. It had a Muslim Nawab with Hindu population.
- 3 Junagarh had a port named Veraval close to city port of Pakistan.
- 4 When the Nawab of Junagarh was travelling, Sir Shah Nawaz Bhutto, the prime minister of Junagarh, in his absence (Nawab was travelling) announced joining Pakistan. It did not make sense geographically.

TROUBLING STATES

INTEGRATION OF JUNAGARH



- 1 On 13 September, Pakistan accepted the accession thinking it could use Junagarh to bargain J&K.
- 2 Sardar Patel was from Junagarh and wanted it to join India. In this regard, India sent a small military force to support them. VP Menon went to Junagarh to negotiate with the Nawab.
- 3 Sir Shah Nawaz decided the issue to be resolved via referendum. Soon the sentiment within Junagarh grew in favour of India. Sir Shah Nawab announced joining India.
- 4 On 9 November, Junagarh was formally transferred to India. But to establish legitimacy, referendum was held on 20 February 1948 with 91 percent favouring accession to India.

POST INDEPENDENCE DEVELOPMENTS

TROUBLING STATES

HYDERABAD



1 Largest Princely state. Hyderabad had a Muslim Ruler with Hindu population.

2 Its ruler was the Nizam who had broken away from the Mughals. Muslims dominated army, police and civil service.

3 Old Hyderabad contained parts of current day Maharashtra, Karnataka and Andhra Pradesh. It had a population speaking Telugu, Kannada and Marathi speaking people.

4 It laid in the center of the subcontinent. Its geographical location was such that if Hyderabad joined Pakistan, it was bound to create communal tensions in both North and South of India.

5 Hence, it was politically and strategically important to integrate Hyderabad.

STAKEHOLDERS IN HYDERABAD



1 The Nizam of Hyderabad, Mir Osman Ali Khan, wanted independence for his state. Hyderabad's independence would separate North and South of India.

2 There were three groupings in Hyderabad:

- ✓ Hyderabad State Congress supporting accession to India
- ✓ Itihad-ul-Muslimeen promoting a paramilitary body called Razakars
- ✓ The Communist Party of India directing rural uprisings and running parallel governments.

INTEGRATION OF HYDERABAD



- 1** On 15 August Congress hoisted Indian flags and razakars resisted calling for free Hyderabad.
- 2** The Conservative Party in Britain supported cause of Hyderabad. Pakistan openly supported Hyderabad.
- 3** In November 1947, the Nizam agreed to sign a Standstill Agreement with India. Under this agreement, Hyderabad would handle its internal affairs and India would manage its foreign affairs.
- 4** Meanwhile by 1948, Itihad's strength was growing. The Razakars sought to fight to maintain Muslim power in the Deccan.
- 5** In the Crossfire between Congress and Hyderabad, Hindus started fleeing to adjoining Madras province. The razakars aimed at making Muslims a majority in Hyderabad. Madras said it was having difficulty in accommodating the refugees.

INTEGRATION OF HYDERABAD



6 In June 1948, VP Menon held meeting with the leaders of Hyderabad in Delhi. He asked the state to introduce representative government and promised plebiscite on accession.

7 On 21 June, Mountbatten resigned as the Governor general and asked the Nizam to join the Union. On 13 September, Indian troops were sent to Hyderabad. the Indian government ordered the Army to control Hyderabad in September 1948 under the name Operation Polo. They controlled the state.

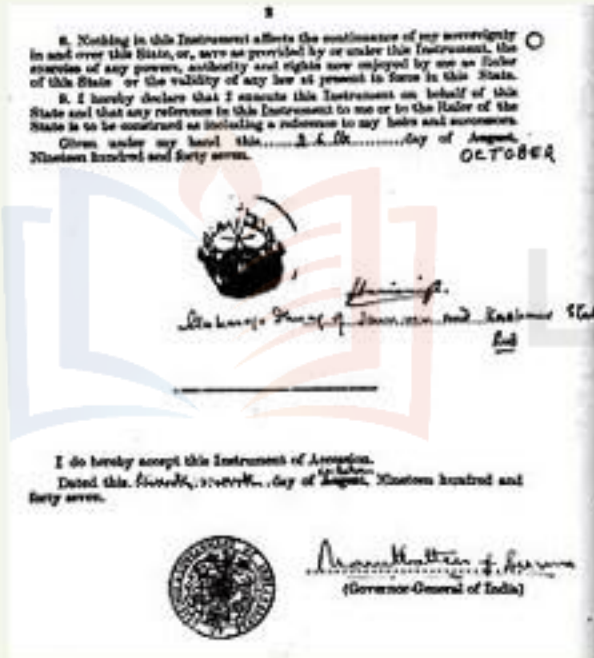
These integrations were major achievements. Sovereignty and power were ultimately transferred to the people.

INTEGRATION OF MANIPUR



- 1 Maharaja of Manipur agreed to sign the Instrument of Accession with the Indian Government on 11 August 1947, provided the internal autonomy of Manipur was secured.
- 2 Because of public pressure, elections were held in the state in 1948.
- 3 Manipur was first Indian part to hold elections and become a constitutional Monarchy on the basis of Universal Adult Franchise.
- 4 India managed to get Manipur sign the Merger Agreement on 21 September 1949 without consulting the popularly elected Legislative Assembly of Manipur.

INSTRUMENT OF ACCESSION VS MERGER AGREEMENT



- Instrument of Accession is a legal document under the Indian Independence Act 1947, on the basis of which a princely state could accede into the Indian Union.
- The Merger Agreement allows that particular state to become a full state in the Union of India.

RECENT NEWS



- 1** In Feb of 2019, a Conference in Mysore was held on princely states focusing on welfare and economic measures. The objective was to generate further research and scholarly literature on the subject. It was attempted to
 - study the economic relationship between the princely states and the British as reflected in the mode of taxes and trade
 - dimensions of relationship between British ruler and princely states.
- 2** These rulers of Mysore, Hyderabad, Travancore, to name a few, had a distinct vision for their future.
- 3** In August 2019, the Supreme Court was dealing with a dispute over succession of private properties of Nawab Raza Ali Khan, the ruler of Rampur.

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